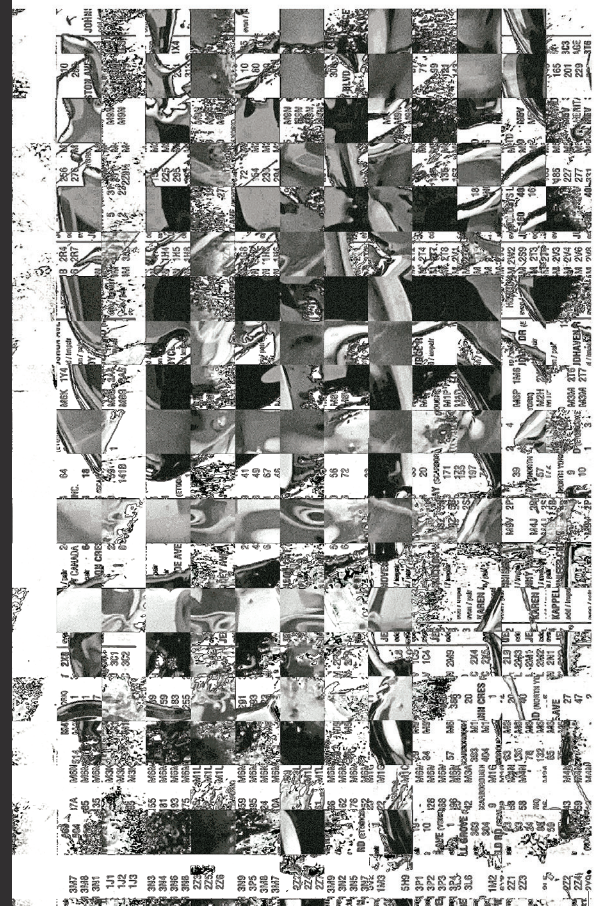
“Not Original”
Instruction Manual by Edie Lamb.



PROJECT

By Edie Lamb for GD4 Project 2: “A Project Submitted to Graphic Design 4 Again.” March 17, 2026.

An instruction manual for redacting and un-redacting original images. This Manual contains step-by-step instructions, visuals, diagrams, and footnotes. The function of the image redaction is to protect your personal work or images from unauthorized reproduction by AI or potential plagiarism.
An encryption method to protect the Original by rendering it Not Original.

IMAGES

Alfred Eisenstaedt, Marilyn Monroe, 1953. B&W Photograph. LIFE Picture Collection.

Edie Lamb, “Irritated Horse,” 2024. B&W film on fiber paper.

TYPEFACE

IBM Corp, “IBM Plex Mono.” Designed by Mike Abbink, Paul van der Laan, and Pieter van Rosmalen. New York, 2017. https://www.ibm.com/plex/.

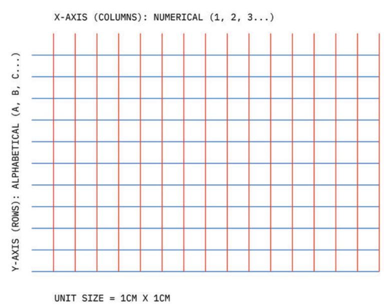
INSTRUCTION

A MANUAL ON “NOT ORIGINAL”
IMAGE REDACTION METHODS.

THE GRID SYSTEM:

The methods taught in this manual are built around a central grid layout. In order for the Redaction-Unredaction processes to work properly, you will need to determine your grid size. Any dimensions will work. For demonstration purposes the grid system in this manual will use 1cm x 1cm dimensions.

Larger grid dimensions require less labour and smaller dimensions will offer more abstract redaction results.



MIRRORING

G. Lay another strip of tape adhesive-side up. Align the strips along their original grid coordinates (1A, 2A, etc.).

H. Secure the back with tape. You should now have the reconstructed version of the original portrait, reflected 4 times.

MIRRORING

E. Rotate the reconstructed sheet 90° counter-clockwise to return to the portrait orientation.

F. Make vertical cuts following the grid dimensions once again.

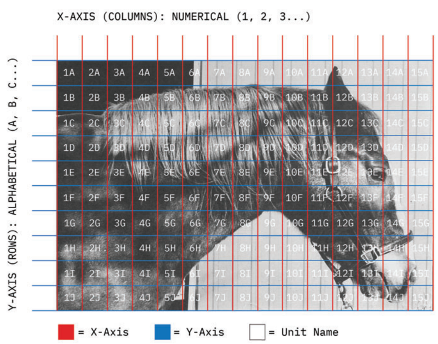
DOWNSCALING

RULESET A: DOWNSCALING

A. Place your image onto the grid system. Assign an alphanumeric coordinate (1A, 1B, 2A...) to every 1cm x 1cm unit, with the top left corner of your image aligned with the grid origin.

B. Record these coordinates either by writing on the back of your image or by keeping a reference or list to refer back to.[1]

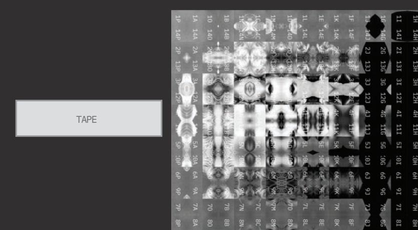
C. Record the total dimensions of your image on the grid (eg, 15 x 22 units).



1. If writing coordinates on the back of your image, keep in mind that flipping the sheet on the horizontal axis will “mirror” the image. You must write coordinates from right-to-left in this case.

MIRRORING

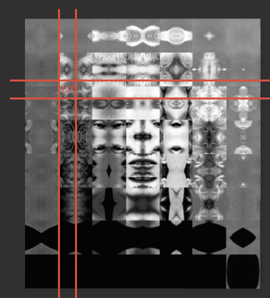
C. Lay a strip of tape adhesive-side up. Identify the center column pairing in the composition.



D. Begin reconstruction by placing the strips in alternating order: Center-Left (C1), Center-Right (C2), C1-1, C2+1, etc. Continue expanding outward until all strips are reordered. Secure the back with tape.

MIRRORING

A. Prepare your mirrored image and a grid layout that matches the dimensions of each “unit” size in the composition.

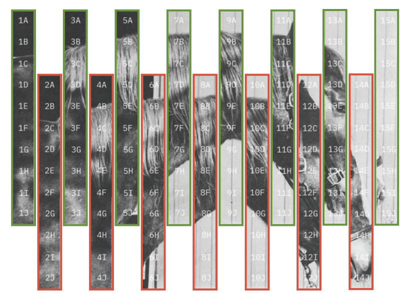


B. Rotate the composition 90° counter-clockwise. Cut vertical strips following the grid dimensions.

Step 1: Vertical

D. Execute vertical cuts along the 1cm guidelines. These strips should all be equally spaced.

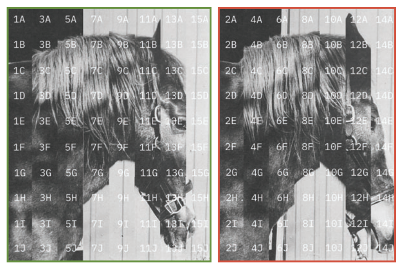
E. Align the strips into the form of the original image. Separate every other strip into two new compositions: Comp-Alpha and Comp-Beta.[3]



3. Comp-Alpha
Comp-Beta

Step 2: Horizontal

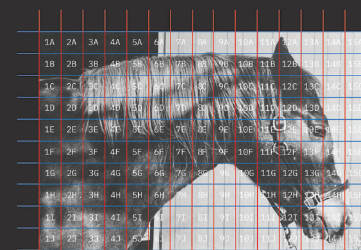
F. All Odd columns move to Comp-Alpha. All even columns move to Comp-Beta.



G. Group the two compositions together side-by-side and tape or secure the back.

DOWNSCALING

E. Find the coordinate attached to the now separated unit, then re-plot it in the corresponding cell on the master grid.



F. Once each unit has been matched to its corresponding cell, secure them together to form the original, unredacted image. (Clear tape over the top is recommended, as accessing the back of the composition will be difficult with the separated units).

DOWNSCALING

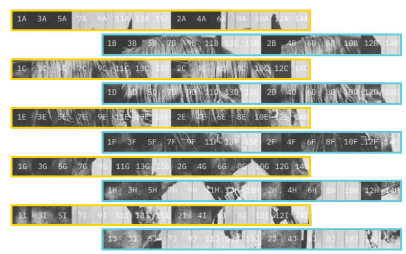
C. Slice vertical cuts in 1cm increments. These cuts should align with the slices visible in the redacted image.

D. Make horizontal slices across the width of the image in 1cm increments. Do not secure or tape the image before cutting, as the unit squares should separate into individual pieces after cutting.

Step 2: Horizontal

H. Execute 1cm wide horizontal cuts across the width of the image.

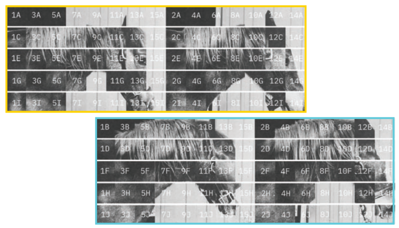
I. Similar to step E, separate every other strip into two new compositions: Comp-Delta and Comp-Gamma.[4]



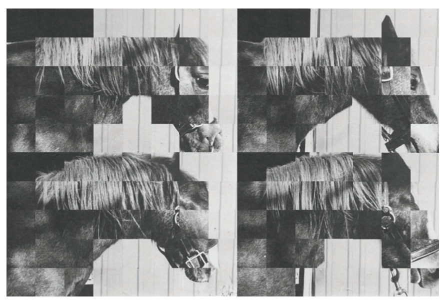
4. Comp-Delta
Comp-Gamma

Step 2: Horizontal

J. Odd rows move to Comp-Delta. Even rows move to Comp-Gamma.



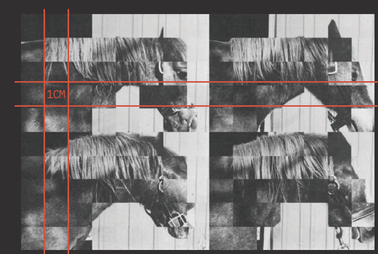
K. Bring Comp-Delta above Comp-Gamma. Tape or secure the back. You will now have 4 downscaled reproductions of your original image.[5]



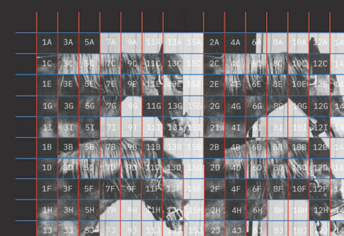
5. The 4 images should now total the same width and length as your original image.

DOWNSCALING

A Take your downscaled image and a ruler. Measure the dimensions of each 'unit' visible in the composition.



B. One the dimensions are determined, prepare a grid with the same dimensions that is large enough to place your image on. Determine the unit names in the grid and place your redacted image with the top-left corner aligned with the grid origin.



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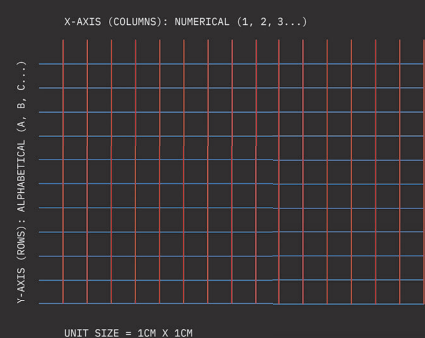
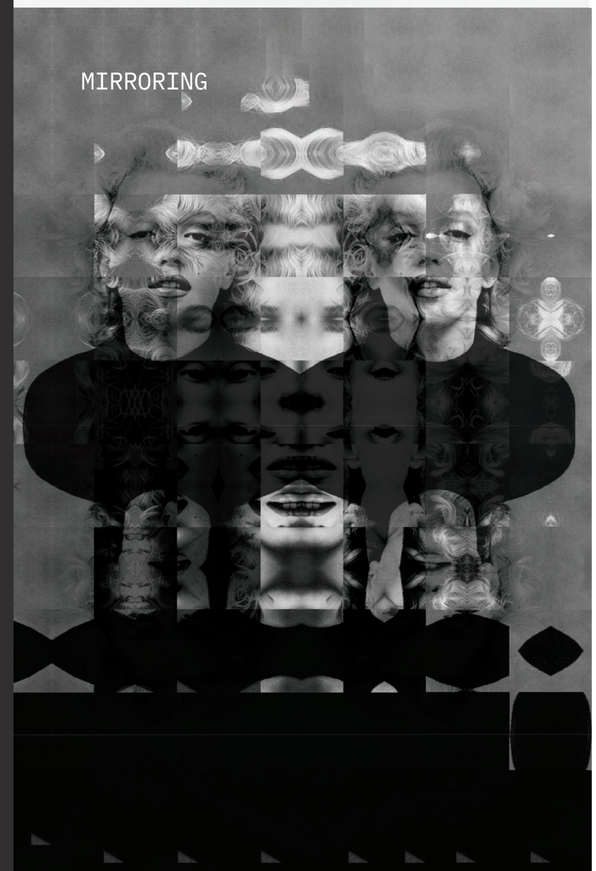




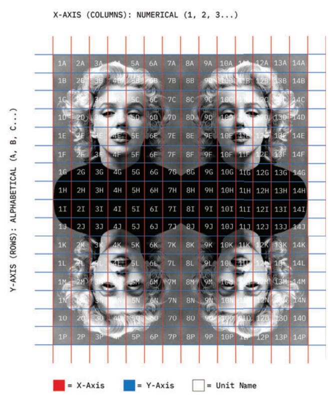
RULESET B: MIRRORING

A. Start with a print of your image reflected 4 times onto a single paper. These should all be ‘mirrored’ images of your original portrait.

B. Place your image onto the grid system. Assign an alphanumeric coordinate (1A, 1B, 2A...) to every unit, with the top left corner of your image aligned with the grid origin.

C. Record these coordinates either by writing on the back of your image or by keeping a reference or list to refer back to.

D. Record the total dimensions of your image on the grid (eg, 15 x 22 units).

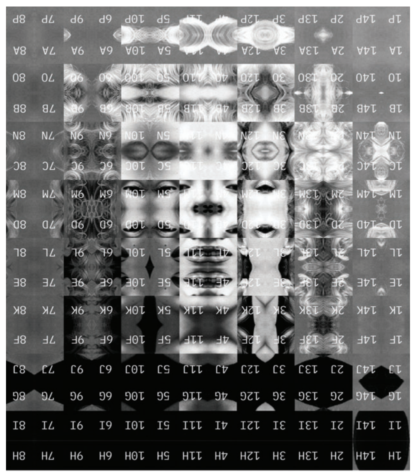


DECONSTRUCTION

A MANUAL ON “ORIGINAL” IMAGE UN-REDACTION METHODS.

Step 2: Horizontal

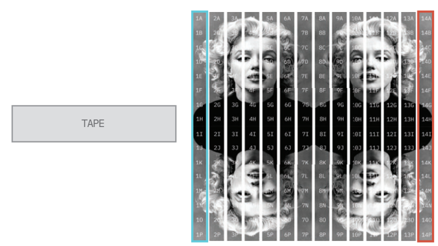
K. Secure the back once more with tape and rotate the compsition 90 degrees clockwise. You should now have an abstract mirrored version of your original image that merges the 4 reflections into one shape.



Step 1: Vertical

E. Execute vertical cuts every 1cm (or your own dimensions) across the total length of the image.

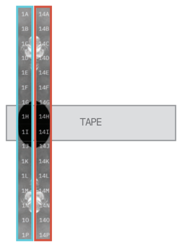
F. Lay out a piece of tape and secure the strips. Identify the Leftmost strip (Column 1) and the Rightmost strip (Column N).[6]



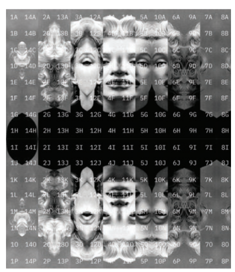
6. Column 1
Column N

Step 1: Vertical

G. Place Column 1 onto the tape starting on the leftmost side. Place Column N immediately to the right of Column 1.[7]



H. Continue the sequence: Column 2, then Column N–1, then Column 3, then Column N–2...[8] until all columns are converged into a new central composition. Secure the full composition.

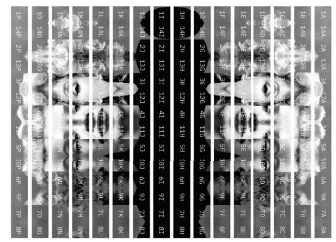


7. The letter ‘N’ stands for ‘Number,’ a placeholder value for the rightmost column in your composition.

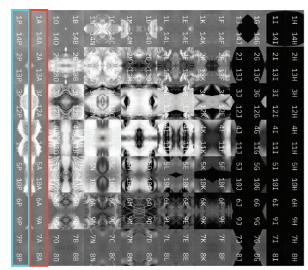
8. In these instructions, the ‘–’ symbol means ‘minus.’ ‘N–1’ means the next column to the right of your ‘N’ column.

Step 2: Horizontal

I. Rotate the new composite 90 degrees clockwise[9] and execute vertical cuts every 1cm along the composition length.



J. Repeat the process outlined in Steps G and H: On a piece of tape, secure Column 1, then Column N, then Column 2, then Column N–1... until all columns are converged into yet another composition.



9. The composition is rotated 90 degrees clockwise and cut vertically again instead of cut horizontally. This is to preserve the overall shape of your image in the outcome.